

HISTORY HACK • DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Read the following two primary source excerpts and answer the prompt below.

US.37 — Examine challenges and advancements related to the push for civil liberties, including (T.C.A. § 49-6- 1006): • First Red Scare • Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s • Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan • Black Wallstreet and Tulsa Massacre • Rise of the NAACP • Efforts of Ida B. Wells-Barnett • Emergence of Garveyism

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document A

A. Mitchell Palmer, U.S. Attorney General, "The Case Against the Reds," Records of the Department of Justice, National Archives (archives.gov), February 1920 (National Archives, Record Group 60 (archives.gov), public domain)

“Each and every adherent of this [communist] movement is a potential murderer or a potential thief... Out of the sly and crafty eyes of many of them leap cupidity, cruelty, insanity, and crime; from their lopsided faces, sloping brows, and misshapen features may be recognized the unmistakable criminal type.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document B

Bartolomeo Vanzetti, Statement after sentencing, Norfolk County Superior Court, April 9, 1927 (court records, public domain)

“I am suffering because I am a radical and indeed I am a radical; I have suffered because I was an Italian, and indeed I am an Italian...Not only am I innocent of these two crimes, but in all my life I have never stolen and never killed and never spilled blood.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Using BOTH documents and your knowledge of the Red Scare (US.28) and the Sacco and Vanzetti case (US.38), write a multi-paragraph response that analyzes each document using the HIPP framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view) and constructs an argument about how anti-radical fear shaped the treatment of immigrants and political dissenters in 1920s America. Your response

1. analyze both documents using HIPP
2. identify what each document reveals about its author's perspective and agenda
3. construct a supported argument using evidence from both documents and your own knowledge

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Full HIPP analysis of both documents (all four elements for each). Constructs a precise argument about anti-radical repression using evidence from both documents. Incorporates at least two pieces of outside evidence. Analysis addresses both documents' perspective/agenda explicitly.
5	Advanced. HIPP analysis of both documents (at least 3 elements each). Constructs a clear argument. Uses evidence from both documents and at least one piece of outside evidence.
4	Proficient. HIPP analysis of both documents (at least 2 elements each). Argument present. Uses evidence from both documents.
3	Adequate. Analyzes both documents with some HIPP elements. Argument present but underdeveloped. May rely mostly on one document.
2	Developing. Some document analysis but HIPP not applied systematically. Argument weak. Limited outside knowledge.
1	Beginning. Minimal document engagement. Summary without analysis. No clear argument.
0	No response or completely off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: Palmer's pseudo-scientific racial language as evidence of purpose; Vanzetti's dual identity (radical + Italian) as evidence of intersecting persecution; both documents produced in legal/political contexts. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Palmer Raids, deportations, ACLU, Schenck, Sacco and Vanzetti trial timeline, Judge Thayer, international protests, execution August 23, 1927.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.